REFERENCE · R6

AI Diligence Statement Template

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

Append a diligence statement to any deliverable that involved AI assistance. The statement makes your AI practices visible to readers. It states what happened, without asking for permission or apologizing. *Length scales with stakes.* The framework's authors close their own document with one: it names the model used, affirms human vetting, and claims full responsibility in five sentences.

Institutions have started to require one. Most journals and conferences already require acknowledgment of AI use, and MIT's 2026 AI committee recommends a statement of AI use in every thesis. The committee holds people responsible for all work they submit, AI-assisted content included, and treats AI as a tool under the direction of a human who verifies its output. Accountability for the deliverable stays with you even when production was delegated; the statement records how you exercised it.

STATEMENT STRUCTURE

Use as a thinking scaffold, then write in continuous prose.

1. DELEGATION: What was delegated?

Which components of the deliverable were AI-generated, AI-assisted, or human-authored?

- Which sections or components did AI produce in full?
- Which sections did AI draft and you revised?
- Which sections did you produce without AI involvement?
- What AI tool and model were used?

> **FILL IN**
>
> *"This [deliverable type] was produced using [tool/model]. The following components were [AI-generated / AI-assisted / human-authored]: [list by section]."*

2. DESCRIPTION: How was the task specified?

What constraints, format, or quality standards were included in the prompt?

- What product specification was given? (format, audience, length)
- What process constraints were set? (framework, data sources)
- What performance instructions shaped the output? (tone, voice)

> **FILL IN**
>
> *"The AI task was specified with the following parameters: [format/audience], using [framework/method], constrained to [data sources/boundaries]."*

3. DISCERNMENT: What was verified?

What verification was performed on the AI-generated content? What was found and corrected?

- Which factual claims or statistics were independently verified?
- What errors were identified and corrected?
- Was reasoning traced step by step or only conclusions reviewed?

> **FILL IN**
>
> *"Verification included [methods]. Claims were checked against [sources]. [Describe corrections, if any]."*

4. DILIGENCE: What limitations remain?

What should the reader be aware of?

- Are there claims that could not be independently verified?
- Are there sections where AI may have introduced subtle bias?
- What should the reader verify independently before acting?

> **FILL IN**
> *"The following limitations should be noted: [unverified claims, caveats]. The reader should [specific advisory]."*

EXAMPLE A: NARRATIVE MODEL

Default for most deliverables. Describes the collaboration model.

AI Diligence Statement: Q3 Market Analysis

Claude (Anthropic) helped us compile the initial data, propose a structure, and draft the descriptive sections of this market analysis. The analytical framework, strategic interpretation, competitive positioning recommendations, and executive summary were developed by the human authors, drawing on internal data sources and domain expertise that were not shared with the AI tool.

Two team members checked every figure in the Claude-drafted sections against the source datasets before the draft went to review. They corrected two misstated growth rates and rewrote passages where the draft claimed more than the data supported. Claude shortened the drafting time; the interpretations are ours, and we answer for any error that remains.

We include this statement so readers can see which parts of the analysis began as AI drafts and weigh them accordingly. Our team attaches one to every client-facing deliverable that involved AI.

Format informed by the Diligence Statement that closes Dakan & Feller's framework document (2025)[1] and the AI Diligence Statement published with Anthropic's AI Fluency course (2025)[2]. The example's wording is original.

EXAMPLE B: STRUCTURED MODEL

For higher-stakes deliverables. Adds section-level attribution and verification detail.

AI Diligence Statement: Client Onboarding Proposal

Delegation: This proposal was produced with AI assistance (Claude, Anthropic). Sections 1–3 (company background, service overview, and timeline) were AI-drafted from source materials we provided and revised by the authoring team. Section 4 (pricing and terms) and Section 5 (team bios and case studies) are entirely human-authored. No proprietary client data was shared with the AI tool.

Description: The AI was directed to produce a formal proposal tone for a C-suite audience, structured around our standard onboarding template, constrained to publicly available company information.

Discernment: All company descriptions, market claims, and competitive references in Sections 1–3 were verified against company filings and our internal research database. Two inaccurate market share characterizations were corrected.

Diligence: Industry growth projections in Section 1 are based on third-party estimates and should be treated as directional, not definitive. The authors take full responsibility for all content and recommendations.

Framework: 4D AI Fluency Framework, Diligence competency (Dakan & Feller, 2025)[3], as taught in Anthropic's AI Fluency course[2]. Statement requirements: MIT Ad Hoc Committee, 2026[4]. Accountability: Lee et al., 2025[5].

Notes

1. Rick Dakan and Joseph Feller, “Framework for AI Fluency: Practical Overview Document (Version 1.1),” Ringling College of Art and Design; University College Cork, January 2025, p. 7, https://ringling.libguides.com/ai/framework
2. Rick Dakan, Joseph Feller, and Anthropic, “AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations (course),” Anthropic Academy, 2025, https://anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-framework-foundations
3. Rick Dakan and Joseph Feller, “Framework for AI Fluency: Practical Overview Document (Version 1.1),” Ringling College of Art and Design; University College Cork, January 2025, p. 6; closing diligence statement, p. 7, https://ringling.libguides.com/ai/framework
4. MIT Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training, “Report of MIT's Ad Hoc Committee on AI Use in Teaching, Learning, and Research Training,” Massachusetts Institute of Technology, August 2026, pp. 16, 22, https://sites.mit.edu/ai-use/files/2026/08/AI-Committee-Final-Report-Aug-13.pdf
5. Hao-Ping (Hank) Lee et al., “The Impact of Generative AI on Critical Thinking: Self-Reported Reductions in Cognitive Effort and Confidence Effects From a Survey of Knowledge Workers,” Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 2025, p. 15 (accountability stays with the human), https://doi.org/10.1145/3706598.3713778

© Michael Ritchot. Code licensed under the MIT License. Instructional content licensed under CC BY-NC-SA 4.0.